



It's hard for a monitor to remain inconspicuous. While other components shrink with each passing year, monitors appear to be getting bulkier—if you ignore the snazzy new LCD monitors, that is.

Yes, monitors are undoubtedly bulky; they hog a lot of power and take up a lot of desk space. However, the monitor is often a long term companion for any PC user, since it does not need to be updated very often—good ones remain trouble-free for years.

The monitor is also one of the more important things to consider while buying or assembling your computer. First of all, the display, which depends on the monitor and the graphics card, is one of the more expensive components that you would buy—it makes up roughly a quarter of the cost of your entire computer system!

Monitors available in the market today support 16.7 million colours and are capable of displaying a resolution of up to 1,600 x 1,200 pixels, at refresh rates as high as 85 Hz. And monitor sizes have now gone up to 22-inches. Due to mass production, large monitors have become affordable; a few years ago such huge monitors could be found only in laboratories.

There are mainly two technologies available in the CRT (cathode ray tube) monitor segment—Shadow Mask and Sony's Aperture Grille. Both technologies have their pros and cons, and both are doing well in the market. CRT monitors have quite a few disadvantages over the other alternative—LCDs.

CRT monitors are heavy and bulky, and power-hungry. Their high-voltage electric field, high and low frequency magnetic fields and radiation may be harmful to users, and the scanning technology they employ makes flickering unavoidable, causing eye strain and fatigue. Their surface is often curved and therefore the lines don't appear straight at the edges, hindering design focused activities.

LCD monitors, on the other hand, use a completely different technology. These monitors are not only more compact, they also consume less power. Inevitably, they are also more expensive than their CRT counterparts,

because of the complexity of the technology and the high rejection rate during manufacture. LCD monitors are also much brighter than CRT ones.

The only problem with LCD displays was that the person using it had to sit exactly in front of it—you cannot view the content on the screen from an angle.

This problem has been taken care of, to some extent in current LCDs. The phosphor in CRT monitors, on the other hand, emit light in all directions, making it possible to view content even from an angle of 180-degrees.

The sales of LCD screens are picking up, especially in the office users segment in metro cities. Since some LCD screens can be wall-mounted, these have found a place in departmental stores and public places such as railway stations, airports and hospitals for the display of information.

Apart from CRT and LCD, there are other display technologies such as gas plasma display, but due to the high prices involved, along with non-suitability for high-end graphics and games, these are not very popular.

Market Overview

LCD is fast becoming the display solution of choice in offices, thanks to its small size and elegant looks—not to forget prices that are dropping fast. For CRT the shift in the last six months has been from 15-inch to 17-inch monitors.

Small, 15-inch CRTs have become popular in the SoHo segment, where there is a need to cut costs. Another reason why users are increasingly opting for bigger monitors is the fact that high-end graphics cards are eas-







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